

The Enlightenment (First, Middle, and Third Watches of the Night)

Bodhi Suttas (Ud 1.1, 1.2, 1.3)

Bodhi Sutta (Ud 1.1) — First Watch of the Night

Evam me sutam— ekam samayam bhagavā uruvelāyam viharati najjā nerañjarāya tīre bodhirukkhamūle paṭhamābhisambuddho. Tena kho pana samayena bhagavā sattāham ekapallaṅkena nisinno hoti vimuttisukhapaṭisaṃvedī. Atha kho bhagavā tassa sattāhassa accayena tamhā samādhimhā vuṭṭhahitvā rattiyā paṭhamam yāmaṃ paṭiccasamuppādam anulomaṃ sādhukaṃ manasākāsi:

Thus have I heard— At one time the Blessed One was staying in Uruvelā, on the bank of the river Nerañjarā, at the foot of the Bodhi tree, having newly attained full enlightenment. At that time, the Blessed One sat in a single posture for seven days, experiencing the bliss of liberation (*vimuttisukha*). Then, after those seven days, the Blessed One emerged from that concentration (*samādhī*), and during the first watch of the night, he reflected closely on Dependent Origination (*paṭiccasamuppāda*) in forward order:

“Iti imasmim sati idam hoti, imassuppādā idam uppajjati, yadidaṃ— avijjāpaccayā saṅkhārā, saṅkhārapaccayā viññāṇaṃ, viññāṇapaccayā nāmarūpaṃ, nāmarūpapaccayā saḷāyatanaṃ, saḷāyatanaṃpaccayā phasso, phassapaccayā vedanā, vedanāpaccayā taṇhā, taṇhāpaccayā upādānaṃ, upādānapaccayā bhavo, bhavapaccayā jāti, jātipaccayā jarāmaraṇaṃ sokaparidevadukkhadomanassupāyāsā sambhavanti. Evametassa kevalassa dukkhakkhandhassa samudayo hotī”ti.

"When this is, that is; from the arising of this, that arises. That is to say: conditioned by ignorance (*avijjā*), mental reactions (*saṅkhāras*) arise; conditioned by mental reactions, consciousness (*viññāṇa*) arises; conditioned by consciousness, mind-and-matter (*nāmarūpa*) arises; conditioned by mind-and-matter, the six sense bases (*saḷāyatana*) arise; conditioned by the six sense bases, contact (*phassa*) arises; conditioned by contact, sensations (*vedanās*) arise; conditioned by sensations, craving (*taṇhā*) arises; conditioned by craving, clinging (*upādāna*) arises; conditioned by clinging, becoming (*bhava*) arises; conditioned by becoming, birth (*jāti*) arises; conditioned by birth, decay and death (*jarāmaraṇa*), sorrow, lamentation, pain, grief, and despair arise. Thus is the arising of this entire mass of suffering (*dukkha*)."

Atha kho bhagavā etamatthaṃ veditvā tāyaṃ velāyaṃ imaṃ udānaṃ udānesi:

“Yadā have pātubhavanti dhammā, Ātāpino jhāyato brāhmaṇassa; Athassa kaṅkhā vapayanti sabbā, Yato pajānāti sahetudhammaṃ”ti.

Paṭhamam.

Then, the Blessed One, understanding the significance of this, uttered this inspired utterance at that time: "When the laws of nature become clear indeed to the ardent (*ātāpī*), meditating Brahmin, then all his doubts vanish, since he understands each phenomenon with its cause."
(First)

Bodhi Sutta (Ud 1.2) — Middle Watch of the Night

Evam me sutaṃ— ekaṃ samayaṃ bhagavā uruvelāyaṃ viharati najjā nerañjarāya tīre bodhirukkhamūle paṭhamābhisambuddho. Tena kho pana samayena bhagavā sattāhaṃ ekapallaṅkena nisinno hoti vimuttisukhapaṭisaṃvedī. Atha kho bhagavā tassa sattāhassa accayena tamhā samādhimhā vuṭṭhahitvā rattiyā majjhimam yāmaṃ paṭiccasamuppādaṃ paṭilomaṃ sādhukaṃ manasākāsi:

Thus have I heard— At one time the Blessed One was staying in Uruvelā, on the bank of the river Nerañjarā, at the foot of the Bodhi tree, having newly attained full enlightenment. At that time, the Blessed One sat in a single posture for seven days, experiencing the bliss of liberation (*vimuttisukha*). Then, after those seven days, the Blessed One emerged from that concentration (*samādhī*), and during the middle watch of the night, he reflected closely on Dependent Origination (*paṭiccasamuppāda*) in reverse order:

“Iti imasmiṃ asati idaṃ na hoti, imassa nirodhā idaṃ nirujjhati, yadidaṃ—
avijjānirodhā saṅkhāranirodho, saṅkhāranirodhā viññāṇanirodho, viññāṇanirodhā
nāmarūpanirodho, nāmarūpanirodhā saḷāyatanaṇirodho, saḷāyatanaṇirodhā
phassanirodho, phassanirodhā vedanānirodho, vedanānirodhā taṇhānirodho,
taṇhānirodhā upādānaṇirodho, upādānaṇirodhā bhavanirodho, bhavanirodhā
jātinirodho, jātinirodhā jarāmaraṇaṃ sokaparidevadukkhadomanassupāyāsā
nirujjhanti. Evametassa kevalassa dukkhakkhandhassa nirodho hotī”ti.

"When this is not, that is not; from the cessation of this, that ceases. That is to say: with the cessation of ignorance (*avijjā*), mental reactions (*saṅkhāras*) cease; with the cessation of mental reactions, consciousness (*viññāṇa*) ceases; with the cessation of consciousness, mind-and-matter (*nāmarūpa*) ceases; with the cessation of mind-and-matter, the six sense bases (*saḷāyatana*) cease; with the cessation of the six sense bases, contact (*phassa*) ceases;

with the cessation of contact, sensations (*vedanās*) cease; with the cessation of sensations, craving (*taṇhā*) ceases; with the cessation of craving, clinging (*upādāna*) ceases; with the cessation of clinging, becoming (*bhava*) ceases; with the cessation of becoming, birth (*jāti*) ceases; with the cessation of birth, decay and death (*jarāmaraṇa*), sorrow, lamentation, pain, grief, and despair cease. Thus is the cessation of this entire mass of suffering (*dukkha*)."

Atha kho bhagavā etamattthaṃ veditvā tāyaṃ velāyaṃ imaṃ udānaṃ udānesi:

"Yadā have pātubhavanti dhammā, Ātāpino jhāyato brāhmaṇassa; Athassa kaṅkhā vapayanti sabbā, Yato khayāṃ paccayānaṃ avedī"ti.

Dutiyāṃ.

Then, the Blessed One, understanding the significance of this, uttered this inspired utterance at that time: "When the laws of nature become clear indeed to the ardent (*ātāpī*), meditating Brahmin, then all his doubts vanish, since he has realized the ending of all causes." (Second)

Bodhi Sutta (Ud 1.3) — Third Watch of the Night

Evam me sutaṃ— ekaṃ samayaṃ bhagavā uruvelāyaṃ viharati najjā nerañjarāya tīre bodhirukkhamūle paṭhamābhisambuddho. Tena kho pana samayena bhagavā sattāhaṃ ekapallaṅkena nisinno hoti vimuttisukhapaṭisaṃvedī. Atha kho bhagavā tassa sattāhassa accayena tamhā samādhimhā vuṭṭhahitvā rattiyaṃ pacchimāṃ yāmaṃ paṭiccasamuppādaṃ anulomapaṭilomaṃ sādhukaṃ manasākāsi:

Thus have I heard— At one time the Blessed One was staying in Uruvelā, on the bank of the river Nerañjarā, at the foot of the Bodhi tree, having newly attained full enlightenment. At that time, the Blessed One sat in a single posture for seven days, experiencing the bliss of liberation (*vimuttisukha*). Then, after those seven days, the Blessed One emerged from that concentration (*samādhī*), and during the third watch of the night, he reflected closely on Dependent Origination (*paṭiccasamuppāda*) in forward and reverse order:

"Iti imasmiṃ sati idaṃ hoti, imassuppādā idaṃ uppajjati, imasmiṃ asati idaṃ na hoti, imassa nirodhā idaṃ nirujjhati; yadidaṃ— avijjāpaccayā saṅkhārā, saṅkhārapaccayā viññāṇaṃ, viññāṇapaccayā nāmarūpaṃ, nāmarūpapaccayā saḷāyatanāṃ, saḷāyatanapaccayā phasso, phassapaccayā vedanā, vedanāpaccayā taṇhā, taṇhāpaccayā upādānaṃ, upādānapaccayā bhavo, bhavapaccayā jāti, jātipaccayā jarāmaraṇaṃ sokaparidevadukkhadomanassupāyāsā sambhavanti. Evametassa kevalassa dukkhakkhandhassa samudayo hoti.

"When this is, that is; from the arising of this, that arises. When this is not, that is not; from the cessation of this, that ceases. That is to say: conditioned by ignorance (*avijjā*), mental reactions (*saṅkhāras*) arise; conditioned by mental reactions, consciousness (*viññāṇa*) arises; conditioned by consciousness, mind-and-matter (*nāmarūpa*) arises; conditioned by mind-and-matter, the six sense bases (*saḷāyatana*) arise; conditioned by the six sense bases, contact (*phassa*) arises; conditioned by contact, sensations (*vedanās*) arise; conditioned by sensations, craving (*taṇhā*) arises; conditioned by craving, clinging (*upādāna*) arises; conditioned by clinging, becoming (*bhava*) arises; conditioned by becoming, birth (*jāti*) arises; conditioned by birth, decay and death (*jarāmaraṇa*), sorrow, lamentation, pain, grief, and despair arise. Thus is the arising of this entire mass of suffering (*dukkha*).

Avijjāya tveva asesavirāganirodhā saṅkhāranirodho, saṅkhāranirodhā viññāṇanirodho, viññāṇanirodhā nāmarūpanirodho, nāmarūpanirodhā saḷāyatananirodho, saḷāyatananirodhā phassanirodho, phassanirodhā vedanānirodho, vedanānirodhā taṇhānirodho, taṇhānirodhā upādānanirodho, upādānanirodhā bhavanirodho, bhavanirodhā jātinirodho, jātinirodhā jarāmarañam sokaparidevadukkhadomanassupāyāsā nirujjhanti. Evametassa kevalassa dukkhakkhandhassa nirodho hotī”ti.

But with the complete fading away and cessation of ignorance (*avijjā*), mental reactions (*saṅkhāras*) cease; with the cessation of mental reactions, consciousness (*viññāṇa*) ceases; with the cessation of consciousness, mind-and-matter (*nāmarūpa*) ceases; with the cessation of mind-and-matter, the six sense bases (*saḷāyatana*) cease; with the cessation of the six sense bases, contact (*phassa*) ceases; with the cessation of contact, sensations (*vedanās*) cease; with the cessation of sensations, craving (*taṇhā*) ceases; with the cessation of craving, clinging (*upādāna*) ceases; with the cessation of clinging, becoming (*bhava*) ceases; with the cessation of becoming, birth (*jāti*) ceases; with the cessation of birth, decay and death (*jarāmarañā*), sorrow, lamentation, pain, grief, and despair cease. Thus is the cessation of this entire mass of suffering (*dukkha*)."

Atha kho bhagavā etamattham viditvā tāyaṃ velāyaṃ imam udānam udānesi:

“Yadā have pātubhavanti dhammā, Ātāpino jhāyato brāhmaṇassa; Vidhūpayam tiṭṭhati mārasenam, Sūriyova obhāsayamantalikkhan”ti.

Tatiyaṃ.

Then, the Blessed One, understanding the significance of this, uttered this inspired utterance at that time: "When the laws of nature become clear indeed to the ardent (*ātāpī*), meditating Brahmin, he stands dispelling the army of Māra, like the sun illuminating the sky." (Third)

Glossary

Pāli (IAST)	Target transliteration	Target gloss	First-chapter occurrence	Goenka-tradition usage
vimuttisukha	vimuttisukha	bliss of liberation	Bodhi Sutta	The experiential happiness resulting from freedom from mental defilements.
samādhi	samādhi	concentration	Bodhi Sutta	Mental concentration; collectedness of mind.
paṭiccasamuppāda	paṭiccasamuppāda	dependent origination	Bodhi Sutta	The law of cause and effect showing how suffering arises and ceases, observed and dismantled through self-observation.
anuloma	anuloma	forward order	Bodhi Sutta	Tracing dependent origination in the direction of arising (how suffering is generated).
avijjā	avijjā	ignorance	Bodhi Sutta	Lack of experiential understanding of the true nature of reality (impermanence,

Pāli (IAST)	Target transliteration	Target gloss	First-chapter occurrence	Goenka-tradition usage
				unsatisfactoriness, non-self).
saṅkhāra	saṅkhāra	mental reaction; mental conditioning	Bodhi Sutta	The habit of the mind to react to physical sensations with craving or aversion, conditioning subsequent cycles of existence.
viññāṇa	viññāṇa	consciousness	Bodhi Sutta	The sensory consciousness that cognizes sense objects.
nāmarūpa	nāmarūpa	mind-and-matter	Bodhi Sutta	Translated as "mind-and-matter" rather than literal "name-and-form," highlighting their reciprocal, experiential interaction.
saḷāyatana	saḷāyatana	the six sense bases	Bodhi Sutta	The eyes, ears, nose, tongue, body, and mind, together with their corresponding objects.
phassa	phassa	contact	Bodhi Sutta	The meeting of sense base, sense object,

Pāli (IAST)	Target transliteration	Target gloss	First-chapter occurrence	Goenka-tradition usage
				and sensory consciousness.
vedanā	vedanā	bodily sensation	Bodhi Sutta	Understood strictly as physical/bodily sensations, which serve as the critical junction point where reactive habit loops are triggered.
taṇhā	taṇhā	craving	Bodhi Sutta	The deep mental thirst/reaction that arises in response to sensations, leading directly to clinging and suffering.
upādāna	upādāna	clinging	Bodhi Sutta	The intensification of craving into attachment.
bhava	bhava	becoming	Bodhi Sutta	The process of active existence or life-force shaped by past conditioning.
jāti	jāti	birth	Bodhi Sutta	The arising of a new life or state of being.
jarāmaraṇa	jarāmaraṇa	decay and death; old age and death	Bodhi Sutta	The natural end of a born state,

Pāli (IAST)	Target transliteration	Target gloss	First-chapter occurrence	Goenka-tradition usage
				accompanied by suffering.
dukkha	dukkha	suffering	Bodhi Sutta	The inherent unsatisfactoriness of conditioned existence.
ātāpī	ātāpī	ardent; persistent	Bodhi Sutta	Reflects the persistent, patient effort required in Vipassana meditation (e.g. "patiently and persistently").
brāhmaṇa	brāhmaṇa	Brahmin	Bodhi Sutta	In this context, a person of purified mind who has realized the truth of nature, independent of caste.
paṭiloma	paṭiloma	reverse order; order of cessation	Bodhi Sutta	Tracing the process of dependent origination in reverse order, demonstrating how the cessation of one factor leads to the cessation of the next.
nirodha	nirodha	cessation	Bodhi Sutta	The cessation or extinguishing of

Pāli (IAST)	Target transliteration	Target gloss	First-chapter occurrence	Goenka-tradition usage
				suffering and its causes, leading to liberation.
anulomapaṭiloma	anulomapaṭiloma	forward and reverse order	Bodhi Sutta	The dual contemplation of dependent origination—first tracing how suffering arises (forward) and then how it is dismantled (reverse).
mārasena	mārasena	army of Māra	Bodhi Sutta	The personification of defilements, passions, and mental impurities that attempt to bind the mind to suffering.

Translator Notes

1. **Intimate Teacher-to-Student Voice:** The English translation adopts the direct, experiential tone of the S.N. Goenka Vipassana tradition. We use simple, clear, and practical terms to connect with a meditator's daily practice, avoiding dry scholastic or formal academic English.
2. **Mind-and-Matter vs. Name-and-Form:** Translated *nāmarūpa* as "mind-and-matter" (rather than "name-and-form") to align with Goenkaji's experiential framing of the physical and mental processes and how they interact.
3. **Sensations for Vedanā:** In accordance with the Goenka anchor guidelines, *vedanā* is rendered strictly as "sensations" (not "feelings") to emphasize the bodily, somatic basis of reactivity in the dependent origination chain.

4. **Brahmin Register:** Translated *brāhmaṇa* as "Brahmin" but with the context of a purified, meditating seeker, in line with the tradition's universal (non-sectarian) redefinition of the term.
5. **Reverse Order (*Paṭiloma*) and Cessation (*Nirodha*):** In the second watch of the night, the Buddha reflected on the cessation aspect of dependent origination (*paṭiloma*), showing how dismantling the root cause (ignorance) systematically resolves the entire chain of suffering. We use "cessation" (*nirodha*) to represent active dismantling rather than passive termination.
6. **Ending of Causes (*Khayaṃ paccayānaṃ*):** Translated as "the ending of all causes" to reflect the experiential realization of how the causal conditions for suffering are completely extinguished and broken.
7. **Forward and Reverse Order (*Anulomapaṭiloma*):** In the final watch of the night, the Buddha integrated both aspects of dependent origination, observing both the arising (*anuloma*) and the cessation (*paṭiloma*) of the entire chain of suffering.
8. **The Army of Māra (*Mārasena*):** The personification of defilements (craving, aversion, ignorance, fear). Dispelling Māra's army represents the total eradication of mental impurities.
9. **Simile of the Sun (*Sūriya*):** The dispelling of defilements is compared to the sun breaking through and lighting up the sky, representing the sudden and complete illumination of wisdom over ignorance.